

BIOL 005B Final Project Guidelines

People learn and demonstrate their knowledge in different ways. Exams don't always measure knowledge equitably! This final project provides you with the ability to demonstrate your knowledge of course materials in a way that is authentic to you.

Your goal is to creatively explain a topic covered this quarter in BIOL 005B. Please refer to the first page of our syllabus for a list of topics we covered this quarter. **You may complete this project in pairs or on your own.** If you choose to complete the project in pairs, both you and your partner must both submit your project on Canvas.

As a reminder, this final project is an alternative form of assessment to a final exam. **You may choose to complete either the final project or final exam. You are not required to do both!** This project is designed to require as much effort as studying and taking a final exam. **This assignment is due on Saturday, August 29th, at 5:30pm.**

Project options

For those of us who are nervous, please be reassured that this is not an art class. I'm not looking for something that could be painted by Rembrandt or written by Plath. I'm hoping to see an explanation of a course topic that shows off your personality and interests! Below is a list of potential mediums for your final project and their size requirements:

- ✿ **Fictional short story** (minimum of 0.75 pages, single spaced)
- ✿ **Popular science essay** for the general public (minimum of 0.75 pages, single spaced)
- ✿ **Poem** (no length requirements)
- ✿ **Video skit** (1-3 minutes)
- ✿ **Informational video** (1-3 minutes)
- ✿ **Music parody** (1-3 minutes, or length of song)
- ✿ **Drawing/painting** (no size requirements)
- ✿ **Infographic/collage** (no size requirements)
- ✿ **Zine** (no length requirements)
- ✿ **Sculpture** (no size requirements)
- ✿ **Textile work** like knitting/crocheting/embroidering/weaving (no size requirements)
- ✿ **Cooking/baking** (no size requirements)

If you have an alternative creative project not listed here that you would like to complete for your final, or if you are uncertain about the viability of your idea, please let me know! I will give you feedback to ensure your idea meets the project guidelines.

Reflection

Along with your creative piece, you must submit a 150-250 word reflection answering these five guiding questions:

- ✿ **What BIOL 005B topic did you choose?**
- ✿ **How does your piece relate to your chosen topic and the course as a whole?**
- ✿ **What was your thought process behind your piece?** How did you come up with your idea? Did anything in particular inspire you?
- ✿ **Were there any unexpected difficulties you encountered during the making of your piece?**

- ✿ **What are your main takeaways from creating this project?** These takeaways don't necessarily have to be about course content. We are always learning things about ourselves and the world around us!

Rubric

There are 80 points possible for this project. You will be graded on four criteria: the size of the project (such as page and time limits), the content of the project, the quality of your reflection, and the effort you put into the project. Each criterion will be evaluated on a five-point scale. Your score out of five for each project will be scaled to reflect a given criterion's point value. For example, if you received a 4/5 in the "Content" category, you will earn 28 points for the accuracy of your project's contents. Please see the rubric below for more detailed grading criteria:

Criteria Score	Size (5pts)	Content (35pts)	Reflection (25pts)	Effort (15pts)
5	Project meets given size requirements	Course content is thoroughly and accurately represented	Reflection thoughtfully answers all five guiding questions	Project shows off student's personality and interests
4		Course content is represented with minimal (1-2) inaccuracies	Reflection thoughtfully answers 4/5 guiding questions	
3		Course content is represented with some (3-5) inaccuracies	Reflection thoughtfully answers 3/5 guiding questions	Some effort
2		Course content is represented with fundamental inaccuracies	Reflection thoughtfully answers 2/5 guiding questions	
1	Project does not meet given size requirements	Topic is not related to course	Reflection answers 1/5 guiding questions, or answers questions with little thought	Little to no effort

As per the course syllabus, please do not use AI unless you want to make me very sad. Projects that use AI will automatically be given a zero.

Project Examples

If you're looking for inspiration, check out some of these project examples! These examples are just meant to show you how much freedom you have in creating your final project. Please do not copy any of these examples!

- ✿ **Birdsong**, a **sci-fi story** I wrote about habitat destruction and fascism for an environmental health class
- ✿ **Orcas: Culture Beneath the Surface** and **Does life have a purpose?**, two very different **popular science essays**
- ✿ **Dicot & Anthophila**, a long-form **poem** I wrote about phenological mismatch
- ✿ **The Life of a Proton**, a **video skit** my former students made about energy in gradients
- ✿ An **informational video** my former students made about circulation
- ✿ **All about That Base (No Acid)**, a **music parody** about bases and acids by *acapella-science2* on YouTube
- ✿ A **zine** my friend Audrey Burr made about symbiosis